Current Events Presentations

Guidelines & Rubric | ECO 112: Principles of Macroeconomics | Fall 2026

Overview

Starting with Chapter 7, small groups will lead a short presentation connecting that week's chapter to a real, current economic event. The goal is to show that you can take an abstract concept from lecture and actually *use* it to make sense of something happening right now.

There are **7 presentation slots** across the semester (Ch 7, 8, 10, 11, 12, 14–15, 16–17). Group sizes and the sign-up schedule will be organized in the Presentations Drive folder

What to Prepare

1. **Find one article or video** (published within the last ~12 months) that connects to that week's chapter: a news article, a Federal Reserve or BLS/BEA report, a Planet Money or similar podcast episode, etc.
2. **Prepare a short presentation (8–10 minutes)**:

- Briefly summarize the article/video (don't assume the class read it)
- Explain the economic concept(s) from the chapter that it illustrates
- State clearly: what does this article get right or wrong, from an economics standpoint?

3. **Prepare 2–3 discussion questions** to open up to the class afterward (5–10 minutes of discussion time).

Logistics

- Presentations happen on **Thursdays**, at the start of class.
- Every group member should speak for some portion of the presentation, this is graded individually (see the rubric below), not shared across the group.
- **Slides are required.** Build your slides in Google Slides and upload them to your group's folder in the shared Presentations Drive folder before your presentation slot.
- If a scheduled Thursday session is canceled, that group presents together with the following week's group instead, so no slot is skipped.

AI Policy: Yellow

AI is fine for finding articles or brainstorming discussion questions, not for writing your analysis or answers. The real test happens live, fielding questions in front of the class.

Grading Rubric (100 points)

The first five criteria below are scored once per **group**, everyone on the team receives the same score for these. **Individual delivery** is scored separately for each **student**, based on whether that person can clearly explain their portion of the material and field a follow-up question live.

Criterion	Points	Scored	What we're looking for
Article relevance & currency	15	Group	Source is genuinely recent and clearly connects to the week's chapter.
Accuracy of economic content	25	Group	Concepts from the chapter are explained correctly and applied appropriately to the article.
Clarity & organization	15	Group	Presentation has a clear structure; the class can follow the argument without having read the source themselves.
Critical engagement	20	Group	Goes beyond summarizing to identify what the article gets right/wrong, or what it leaves out.

Criterion	Points	Scored	What we're looking for
Discussion questions & facilitation	15	Group	Questions are genuinely discussable (not yes/no); group manages the discussion rather than just reading questions off a slide.
Individual delivery	10	Individual	This student speaks clearly, has command of their portion, and can answer a follow-up question about it without relying on teammates.

Grade Bands

- **90–100:** Sharp article choice, correct and well-applied economics, genuinely sparks discussion.
- **75–89:** Solid effort, mostly correct economics, discussion questions land but may need instructor prompting.
- **60–74:** Article connection is loose or economics has real gaps; presentation is more summary than analysis.
- **Below 60:** Article not clearly relevant, economic content is largely incorrect, or discussion component is missing.

A Few Tips

- The best presentations pick an article that has some tension or ambiguity in it: a policy debate, a surprising data release, a case where people disagree about the right interpretation. A totally settled, uncontroversial article makes for a short discussion.
- FRED (fred.stlouisfed.org) is a great place to pull an actual chart to show alongside your article. Real data makes the presentation land better than description alone.